

Maktab Khana

مکتب خانہ

1. Basic Facts

- Also spelled: Makatib Khana / Makateeb Khana (variant transliterations of the same name)
- Built by: Associated with Emperor Jahangir's reign; construction supervised by the architect Abdul Karim Mamur Khan
- Built in: Jahangir first mentions his alterations to the fort in 1612 when describing the Maktab Khana, according to one source; another source dates construction to 1617-18, alongside the neighbouring Daulat Khana
- Built for: An administrative/record-keeping building - the name translates roughly as "Clerk's Quarters"

2. Construction Details

- Form: A Persian-style compound built around pointed-arch arcades, with a deep iwan (a vaulted, rectangular entrance hall open on one side) set at the centre of each of its four sides
- Location: Near the Moti Masjid, understood to form part of the wider Daulat Khana-e-Jahangiri complex
- Materials: Not documented in detail beyond its general Jahangir-period masonry construction

3. Historical Background

- Most likely functioned as an inscription and record-keeping facility serving the emperor's residence, consistent with its "Clerk's Quarters" name.
- Architectural historians treat it as most likely part of the larger Daulat Khana-e-Jahangiri complex rather than a fully independent structure - the two are closely linked both by location and by function, though your classifier (and this report) treat them as the two separate labelled structures you are training on.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- Jahangir's own writings are cited as the earliest reference to this building (1612), making it one of the few structures in the fort whose earliest mention comes directly from an emperor's personal account rather than a later historian.
- Its distinctive four-iwan plan (a symmetrical arrangement with a vaulted hall on each side) is a classic Persian architectural layout, applied here to what was essentially a administrative record office rather than a religious or ceremonial building.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Behind the grandeur of marble halls, a much quieter four-sided compound did the paperwork of empire - petitions logged, letters copied, records kept, each of its four vaulted halls facing inward toward the same courtyard - the kind of ordinary bureaucratic labour that rarely gets painted on a Picture Wall, but without which none of the ceremony elsewhere in the fort could actually function.

AI Heritage Revive — Lahore Fort landmark reference. Compiled from encyclopedic research report; figures marked "Not documented" are intentionally left blank rather than estimated.